

SENATE No. 2686

Senate, October 30, 2025 -- Resolutions (filed by Senator Rodrigues) calling on the President of the United States to release contingency funds for the supplemental nutrition assistance program for the duration of the ongoing federal government shutdown

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

RESOLUTIONS CALLING ON THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES TO RELEASE CONTINGENCY FUNDS FOR THE SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM FOR THE DURATION OF THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN.

1 WHEREAS, ON OCTOBER 26, 2025, THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION INFORMED
2 STATES THROUGHOUT THE NATION THAT STARTING ON NOVEMBER 1, 2025, THE
3 FEDERALLY-FUNDED SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM
4 WOULD NOT BE AVAILABLE DUE TO THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT
5 SHUTDOWN; AND

6 WHEREAS, REPORTS FROM THE CENTER ON BUDGET AND POLICY
7 PRIORITIES AND OTHERS INDICATE THAT THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION HAS
8 THE AUTHORITY TO ALLOCATE FUNDS FROM A FEDERALLY-ESTABLISHED
9 CONTINGENCY FUND TO COVER SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE
10 PROGRAM BENEFITS AND THE CONTINGENCY FUND CURRENTLY TOTALS OVER
11 \$5,000,000,000; AND

12 WHEREAS, DURING THE 2018 SHUTDOWN, THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION
13 WAS ABLE TO ENSURE THE CONTINUITY OF SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION
14 ASSISTANCE PROGRAM FUNDS TO STATES AND THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION
15 AT THE TIME OPINED THAT CONTINGENCY FUNDS COULD BE USED TO FUND THE
16 SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM; AND

17 WHEREAS, THE CONSEQUENCES OF DECIDING NOT TO FUND THE
18 SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM WOULD EXTEND BEYOND
19 INDIVIDUAL HOUSEHOLDS AND CAUSE A DISRUPTION IN SUPPLEMENTAL
20 NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM BENEFITS THAT WOULD DESTABILIZE THE
21 COMMONWEALTH'S FOOD ECONOMY; AND

22 WHEREAS, HUNGER AND HARDSHIP WILL RISE IMMEDIATELY AND
23 MEASURABLY, DISPROPORTIONATELY BURDENING SENIORS, CHILDREN AND
24 INDIVIDUALS LIVING WITH DISABILITIES; NOW THEREFORE BE IT

25 RESOLVED, THAT THE MASSACHUSETTS SENATE CALLS ON THE
26 PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES TO RELEASE CONTINGENCY FUNDS FOR THE
27 SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM THROUGH THE DURATION
28 OF THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN; AND BE IT FURTHER

29 RESOLVED, THAT A COPY OF THESE RESOLUTIONS BE TRANSMITTED
30 FORTHWITH BY THE CLERK OF THE SENATE TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED
31 STATES AND THE MASSACHUSETTS CONGRESSIONAL DELEGATION.

SUBMITTED BY:

SENATOR RODRIGUES